

i-Ready Outcomes Analysis

Rapid Cycle Evaluation Summary for Sample School District

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Rapid Cycle Evaluation Overview

LearnPlatform's Research team prepared and ran rapid cycle evaluations on *i-Ready* using the following research designs:

1. Association of time on task with i-Ready's internal diagnostic scores, Kindergarten through 12th grade, for the 2025–2026 academic year
2. Association of time on task with SmarterBalanced state summative scores, run separately for each tested grade (3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, and 10)

Summary Results

- + Students in grades **Kindergarten through 8th** who spent more time on task in *i-Ready* Math had higher diagnostic scores. This same relationship held up on the state summative test in grades 3, 4, 7, and 8 — two independent measures agreeing is a stronger signal than either alone.
- + The relationship was strongest in grades 3 and 4, where **both** the internal diagnostic and the state test agreed, in both Math and ELA. It faded through the middle grades and was not significant by high school.
- + Across all grades, **14,081 students** were included in the district-wide diagnostic analysis. No usage/dosage goal was configured for this trial, so this brief reports average time on task rather than a compliance rate.

Rapid Cycle Evaluation Overview

LearnPlatform by Instructure (LearnPlatform), in collaboration with Sample School District, conducted a total of **16 Rapid Cycle Evaluations (RCEs)** to examine the relationship between *i-Ready* usage and both its internal diagnostic and SmarterBalanced state summative scores.¹ The diagnostic-based RCEs were designed to satisfy Level III requirements (Promising Evidence) according to the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) (see Appendix A for more information on ESSA), and results from both outcome measures were compared for agreement wherever both were available at the same grade.

¹ LearnPlatform by Instructure's RCE reports are generated using IMPACT 2.0. This software supports a range of research designs and methods that enable systematic examinations of product usage and outcomes within diverse educational contexts.

Overview of Measures, Samples, and Findings across RCEs

The RCEs used data from 09/02/2025–06/23/2026 to provide Sample School District with insights into the implementation of *i-Ready* and the relationship with student outcomes. Sample School District provided LearnPlatform with data on product usage and student demographics and outcomes (see Table 1) (see Appendix B for subgroup-level findings).

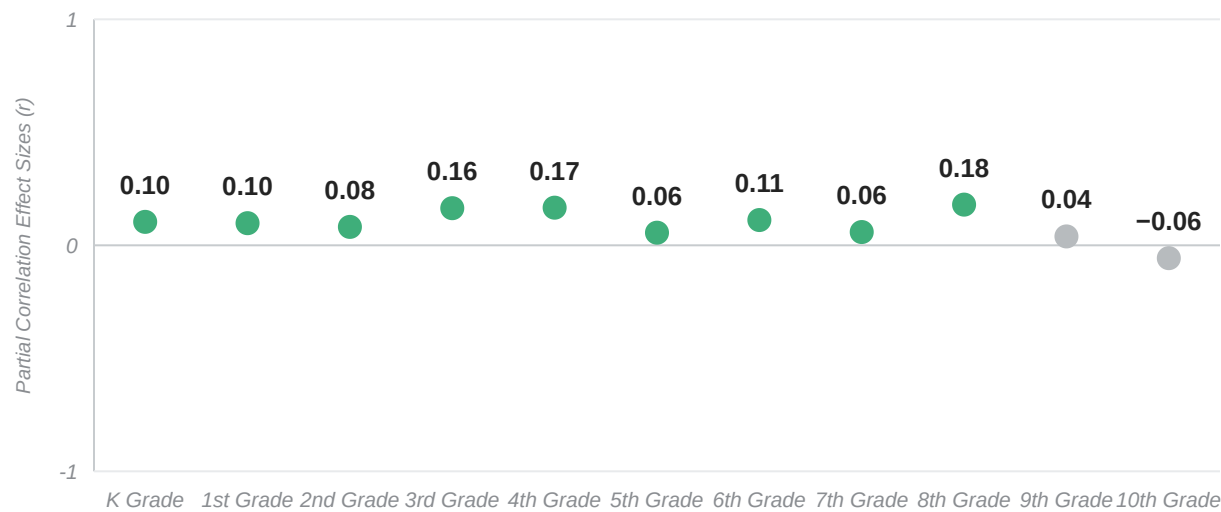
Table 1. Descriptions of the RCE sample, usage, and outcomes included in the *i-Ready* analyses.

Number of RCEs	Overall Effectiveness (Math, K-8)	Overall Statistical Significance	Grade Level(s)	Sample Size Range	Usage Metric(s)	Outcome(s)
16	+.06 to +.18	Positive	K-8 (diagnostic) · 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10 (state test)	1,275–1,934	Time on Task (ELA & Math)	i-Ready Diagnostic · SmarterBalanced

Summary of Impacts

The RCEs used descriptive statistics to support usage analyses and partial correlations² to examine how time on task relates to outcomes. Findings indicate that students in grades Kindergarten through 8th who spent more time on task in *i-Ready* Math had higher diagnostic scores. The same relationship faded by grade 9 and was not statistically significant in grades 9 or 10.

Table 2. RCEs on *i-Ready* Math in Sample School District satisfy ESSA evidence requirements for **Level III (Promising Evidence)** for students' math outcomes in grades K-8 when looking at the internal diagnostic assessment.



Partial correlation effect sizes by grade — *i-Ready* diagnostic, Math. Green = statistically significant; gray = not significant.



A second, independent outcome measure agrees. Washington's SmarterBalanced summative test — run as a separate analysis for each tested grade — also shows significant positive effects in grades 3, 4, 7, and 8, the same direction as the internal diagnostic. Two independently run measures agreeing is stronger evidence than either alone.

² Partial correlations measure the degree of association between *i-Ready* usage and the outcome of interest. The analyses included two covariates to control for potential selection bias: school and grade level. Results specific to school-level effects are in Appendix B.

Next Steps

LearnPlatform recommends finding time to discuss these results with members of your district team (see Appendix C for sample discussion questions). Sample School District can consider additional RCEs on *i-Ready* by utilizing updated usage data and end-of-year scores for the 2026–2027 school year. Setting a usage/dosage goal for this trial, and adding demographic data from your student information system (SIS), would add additional value and validity to future results.

Appendix A

The Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) provides schools and districts with a framework for determining which products are evidence-based and have been shown to improve student or other relevant outcomes. LearnPlatform classifies the research of interventions into one of four ESSA evidence tiers.



ESSA LEVEL IV Demonstrates Rationale

- Research-based logic model for why this product should work
- Blueprint for implementation with fidelity
- Not empirical research — a rationale, not a finding



ESSA LEVEL III Promising Evidence

- Correlational study showing a positive relationship between usage and outcomes
- No comparison group, random assignment, or baseline equivalence
- Most meaningful for districts with similar context



ESSA LEVEL II Moderate Evidence

- Quasi-experimental study showing users outperformed non-users
- Demographically similar comparison group, not randomly assigned
- District context should be strongly considered



ESSA LEVEL I Strong Evidence

- Experimental study proving users outperformed non-users
- Randomized comparison group for highly generalizable evidence
- Establishes eligibility for all types of federal funding

Appendix B

Table B1. Subgroups with a clear positive or negative finding in the *i-Ready* Math RCEs (diagnostic assessment). Subgroups without a statistically significant result are omitted from this table but are discussed in the main findings above.

Effectiveness	ESSA Level	Subgroup	Grade Level(s)	Usage Metric	Outcome(s)
Positive	III	Gender = Male	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	Gender = Female	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	Ethnicity = White	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	Ethnicity = Black or African-American	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	Ethnicity = Two or More Races	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	Ethnicity = Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander*	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	Free/Reduced Lunch = Yes	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	School = School 1 (highest-showing)	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	School = School 2	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic
Positive	III	School = School 3	K-8	Time on Task	i-Ready Diagnostic

** n = 29, right at the edge of the stability threshold used elsewhere in this pipeline — flagged as a small-sample result, not a headline finding. No subgroup in this analysis showed a statistically significant negative effect.*

Appendix C

1. What could be the reason certain grades or school sites have higher usage or more positive effectiveness?

- a. Are there best practices in the strongest-showing schools or grades (3rd and 4th) that could be replicated elsewhere?
 - b. Are there barriers to implementation that could explain lower usage in grades 9–10?
 - c. Did some sites receive different professional learning opportunities?
2. What does success look like for this product's implementation?
- a. Right now, is usage the most important part of implementation, or should the focus shift to effectiveness once a dosage goal is set?
3. How can we use these results within our district?
- a. Should a usage/dosage goal be defined and communicated to teachers, since none is currently configured?
 - b. Can implementation leaders from the strongest-showing grades support other grades?
4. Can we work with LearnPlatform to iterate on these results — for example, closing the SmarterBalanced grade 10 data-matching gap, or running more specific reports by school or classroom?